

Overcalls

Because of the Defensive element, the most important requirement for an Overcall is that you have a good suit, one that you'd like partner to lead. Keep in mind:

- a 5-card or longer suit with honor strength

- 9-16 points to overcall at the 1-level

- 11-16 points to overcall at the 2-level

Takeout Doubles

There are three kinds of Takeout Double:

- opening hand strength, no more than 2 of opponent's suit, at least 3 in all other suits
- strong Overcall type, at least 17 points and a good suit. Double, then bid the suit.
- strong Notrump type, 19+ points, stopper in their suit. Double, then bid notrump.

Responding to a Takeout Double

- 0-8 points, bid your best suit as cheaply as possible

- 9-11 points, jump in your best suit

- 12 or more points, cue-bid the opponent's suit

Board: 1
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣K

Board: 2
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 1♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣K

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 1♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦K

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 1♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣8

Board: 5
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥3

Board: 6
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 1NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠4

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 6
♥ A Q 10 8
♦ J 10 7 5
♣ Q 10 8 4

♠ K Q J 9 7 5 3

♥ 7 4

♦ Q 3

♣ 6 2



♠ 10 4
♥ K 9 6 3
♦ A 4 2
♣ A K J 9

♠ A 8 2

♥ J 5 2

♦ K 9 8 6

♣ 7 5 3

West

1 ♣

All Pass

3 ♠ by North

Lead: ♣K

North

3 ♠

*East**South*

If West had passed, NORTH would have opened with a preemptive 3 ♠.

She should make the same bid with the same hand AFTER the opponents open. And she makes it for the same reason, to describe her hand and to take away bidding space from the opponents.

SOUTH treats it just like a Preemptive 3-bid, even though it is now called a Weak Jump Overcall. In this case, SOUTH passes.

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 7 2
♥ Q J 5 4
♦ 6 3
♣ 9 8 6 4

♠ 9 6 3

♥ A K 7

♦ 9 4 2

♣ A 10 7 5



♠ A J 10 8 5

♥ 6 3

♦ A J 10 8 5

♣ 3

♠ Q 4

♥ 10 9 8 2

♦ K Q 7

♣ K Q J 2

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♣

1 ♠

All Pass

1 ♠ by East

Lead: ♣K

EAST has 12 points, but with two 5-card suits worthy of an overcall. There isn't really a right and wrong here, but it usually works out best to overcall in the higher-ranking suit. That leaves open the possibility of bidding the second suit later.

In this Deal, after EAST overcalls 1 ♠, that later possibility never happens because everybody should pass.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 5 3
♥ 4 2
♦ A K 2
♣ J 7 6 4 2

♠ K 10 7 4

♥ K J 7

♦ 10 7 6

♣ A Q 3



♠ Q 8 6

♥ Q 8 6 3

♦ 9 8 4 3

♣ 8 5

♠ J 9 2

♥ A 10 9 5

♦ Q J 5

♣ K 10 9

WEST has 13 points but she has to pass. She cannot Double without support for ♥s. She cannot bid 1NT without 2 more points. She cannot overcall 2♣ with a terrible suit like that.

And EAST of course must also pass.

*West**North**East**South*

1♠

All Pass

1♠ by South

Lead: ♦K

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9 7 5
 ♥ A 10 5
 ♦ A 10 9 4
 ♣ J 10 9

♠ K Q J 8 4 2

♥ Q 2

♦ Q 8 7

♣ 8 3



♠ A 6

♥ 9 8 4 3

♦ 6 3 2

♣ K 6 5 4

♠ 10 3

♥ K J 7 6

♦ K J 5

♣ A Q 7 2

West

1 ♠

All Pass

1 ♠ by West

Lead: ♣8

North

Pass

East

Pass

South

Dbl

NORTH obviously has to pass when WEST opens 1 ♠.

SOUTH has a reasonable Takeout Double. She hopes NORTH will name a suit and they can just play a partscore.

You should almost always bid when partner makes a Takeout Double. Almost always. This is the one time when you don't. NORTH's ♠ are so good that he passes, converting the Takeout Double into a Penalty Double.

Board 5

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 4
♥ 10 7 4
♦ Q 4 2
♣ K Q 10 7 3

♠ A K 8 7 2

♥ J 9 8

♦ K 7 6

♣ 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 6 3

♥ 6 5 3

♦ J 10 3

♣ A J 9 8

♠ Q J 5

♥ A K Q 2

♦ A 9 8 5

♣ 4 2

NORTH has a normal overcall of 1 ♠.

SOUTH has a really good hand, but he doesn't have to worry about missing a slam since NORTH will not have more than 16 points. So he just bids what he thinks NORTH can make, 4 ♠.

West

1 ♣

North

1 ♠

East

Pass

South

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

Lead: ♥ 3

Board 6

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 3
♥ K Q J 5 3
♦ 9 6 5
♣ 10 6

♠ 9 7 2

♥ A 6 2

♦ Q 7 2

♣ Q 9 5 3



♠ 10 6 5

♥ 8 4

♦ K J 10 3

♣ A J 8 4

♠ A J 8 4

♥ 10 9 7

♦ A 8 4

♣ K 7 2

WEST has 12 points and a good enough suit to
overcall 1 ♥.

EAST has 9 points with a good ♦ stopper. She bids
1NT.

WEST has nothing more to say, and lets EAST play
1NT.

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♥

Pass

1NT

1 ♦

All Pass

1NT by East

Lead: ♠ 4